

N12 FOOD PRODUCTION | O (MAX : 2 PT)

Intent : Provide opportunities for on-site food production and increase food access.

Summary : This WELL feature requires the provision of space, infrastructure and tools for on-site food production.

Issue : Changing economic and environmental conditions, along with increasing industrialization, have led to both a physical and emotional disconnect between consumers and their food. Most food is produced or processed hundreds of miles from where it is consumed, often threatening local food systems and contributing to a sense of detachment. More recently, consumers have an increasing desire to know how their food is made, raised or grown, in order to better understand the consequences of their food purchases.¹ This has led to the growth of a global movement committed to reconnecting individuals, communities and local food systems.

Solutions : Increasing access to locally grown food is important for many reasons, including food access and social and environmental health. Individuals who participate in community and home gardening projects have higher levels of fruit and vegetable consumption and are more likely to meet national recommendations for fruit and vegetable intakes than nongardeners.²⁻⁴ Individual participation in community agriculture has also been linked to increased household fruit and vegetable intake.² Beyond contributing to nutritional benefits, gardens are associated with several social benefits. Participation in community gardening can help fortify social cohesion and community involvement, increase physical activity, provide on-site educational opportunities and increase perceptions of community safety.^{3,5} Gardening may also benefit mental health, by reducing symptoms of anxiety and depression.⁶

PART 1 PROVIDE GARDENING SPACE (MAX : 2 PT)

For All Spaces except Dwelling Units:

A permanent and accessible space for food production is located within a 400 m walk distance of the project boundary and meets the following requirements:

- a. The space includes at least one of the following:
 1. Garden or greenhouse with food-bearing plants.⁷
 2. Edible landscaping (e.g., fruit trees, herbs).⁷
 3. Hydroponic or aeroponic farming system.
- b. The space is available to regular occupants during the majority of building operating hours. Foods grown are made available to regular occupants.
- c. The space is at least 0.09 m² per regular occupant or 0.05 m² per student, whichever area is greater (up to a maximum of 140 m² and not less than 18.5 m²). The area calculated is the actual growing area (vertical or horizontal) used for the production of food-bearing plants.⁷ For hydroponic and aeroponic farming systems, the project may halve the growing area calculations, given higher yield.
- d. Regular occupants have access to planting supplies, including planting medium, watering system, lighting (interior spaces only), plants and gardening tools.⁷

For Dwelling Units:

A permanent and accessible space for food production is located within a 400 m walk distance of the project boundary and meets the following requirements:

- a. The space includes at least one of the following:
 1. Garden or greenhouse with food-bearing plants.⁷
 2. Edible landscaping (e.g., fruit trees, herbs).⁷
 3. Hydroponic or aeroponic farming system.
- b. The space is open to regular occupants during regular building hours and is accessible the majority of the days in the operating year. Foods grown are made available to regular occupants.
- c. The space is at least 1.4 m² per dwelling unit (up to a maximum of 140 m² and not less than 18.5 m²). The area calculated is the actual growing area (vertical or horizontal) used for the production of food-bearing plants.⁷ For hydroponic and aeroponic farming systems, the project may halve the growing area calculations given higher yield.
- d. The space provides planting supplies, including planting medium, watering system, lighting (interior spaces only), plants and gardening tools.⁷

REFERENCES

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